

NIPLAY

and impressive detail. The autofocus function, bolstered by Nikon's 3D tracking, is a notable improvement over previous Z6 models. Even video, often an afterthought in retro-inspired cameras, gets a significant boost with 4K recording at up to 60p and the addition of 10-bit internal capture with Log and HLG profiles.

However, the Zf's beauty hides compromises made in the pursuit of vintage appeal. The square body isn't comfortable to hold for extended periods, especially with heavier lenses. The lack of an AF joystick, replaced by a less intuitive four-way controller, slows down operation, while the interaction between the dedicated dials and button functions feels oddly implemented. It's almost as if Nikon's engineers, so focussed on recreating the aesthetic of the past, forgot to fully consider the ergonomic needs of the modern photographer.

And this is the crux of the Zf's dilemma. It's caught between two worlds—a nostalgic homage to a bygone era and a modern photographic tool striving for relevance. It excels in bursts, capturing stunning images, nailing critical focus, and turning heads with its timeless design. Yet, in the quiet moments, the compromises become apparent, the cracks in the nostalgic facade revealing a camera that sometimes feels more like a tribute act than a true icon. **BT**

Available on: nikon.co.in

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DELL ALIENWARE M18 R2

₹4,59,489

If ultimate gaming performance is your top priority and portability is a secondary concern, this is for you

REVIEW

Gaming PCs from Alienware, a brand owned by Dell, are known to pack a punch and cost an arm and a leg. Its gaming laptop, the m18 R2, is no different. The review unit features an Intel i9 processor, an Nvidia GeForce RTX 4090 card, a backlit mechanical keyboard—and costs as much as an entry-level small car.

This PC is an absolute powerhouse, capable of running the most demanding games at maximum settings without breaking a sweat. Games like *Horizon Forbidden West* and *Cyberpunk 2077* in RT Overdrive mode, which brings even the most powerful desktops to their knees, run flawlessly on the m18 R2. From CPU-intensive encoding tasks to graphically demanding games, this laptop consistently outperforms other high-end gaming machines.

The gaming experience is enhanced by its keyboard that provides a level of precision and tactile feedback that you won't find on standard laptop keyboards. The 18-inch display offers ample screen real estate for immersive gaming, but its peak brightness of 300 nits is

► **SPECS: 14TH GEN INTEL CORE I9 14900HX; WINDOWS 11 HOME; NVIDIA GEFORCE RTX 4090; 64 GB DDR5 RAM; 1 TB SSD; 18" 2,560X1,600; ALIENFX RGB ULTRA LOW-PROFILE CHERRYMX MECHANICAL LAPTOP KEYBOARD**

disappointing, considering the laptop's premium price.

But this immersive experience comes with some caveats. The m18 R2 weighs over 4.2 kg; plus, the thermal shelf on the back, designed to dissipate heat, adds to the laptop's overall bulk. And expect less than five hours of video playback and just around an hour of gaming on a single charge.

While the Alienware m18 R2's performance often surpasses that of high-end desktops, its size, weight, and limited battery life are significant drawbacks. And with its premium price tag, it is not for everyone. **BT**

Available on: www.dell.com/en-in